

1 TOP 10 REASONS PRIOR AUTHORIZATIONS GET DELAYED

And how to prevent them before submission.

Reduce Delays Prevent Rework Improve Approvals

INCLUDES:

- Top 10 Delay Reasons Guide
- Prevention Strategies
- Root Cause Explanations
- Action Steps
- PDF Download

INSTANT DOWNLOAD

Most delays start before submission.

2 THE BIGGEST CAUSES OF DELAYS

The top 5 reasons requests get delayed most often.

- Missing or Incomplete Clinical Documentation
- Incorrect or Missing CPT / ICD Codes
- Authorization Requirement Not Verified
- Payer-Specific Requirements Not Reviewed
- Inconsistent Intake Process Across Staff

The most common causes are usually preventable.

3 WHY REQUESTS GET STUCK

One small gap can create a chain reaction.

- Missing Information: Important details are not captured.
- Request Returned: Payer requests additional information.
- Additional Follow-Up: More time spent clarifying and collecting.
- Resubmission: Request sent again with missing items.
- Patient Delay: Care is delayed while waiting.
- Operational Rework: Staff time wasted on repeat work.

One small gap creates multiple downstream delays.

4 THE SECONDARY DELAY DRIVERS

Other common issues that cause requests to slow down.

- Delayed Follow-Up After Submission: No timely follow-up on submitted requests.
- Incorrect Submission Method: Wrong portal, fax, or submission route used.
- Lack of Ownership or Tracking: No clear responsibility assigned.
- Requests Fall Through the Cracks: No tracking system in place.
- Rework Due to Missing Information: Issues identified after submission.

Most delays aren't isolated events. They're process failures.

5 WHAT THIS HELPS YOU DO

Shift from reactive to proactive.

BEFORE	AFTER
Constant follow-ups	Faster submissions
Unclear root causes	Better intake accuracy
Repeated delays	Fewer delays
Multiple touchpoints	Clear ownership
Frustrated staff	Better outcomes

Focus on prevention instead of correction.

6 WHO THIS IS FOR

Perfect for teams involved in prior authorizations.

Prior Authorization Teams	Intake Specialists	Revenue Cycle Teams
Patient Access	Referral Coordinators	Operations Leaders

Built from real-world prior authorization workflows.

REDUCE DELAYS
Prevent avoidable delays before they impact patients.

IMPROVE INTAKE
Capture the right information the first time.

FEWER FOLLOW-UPS
Reduce back-and-forth with payers.

SAVE TIME
Eliminate rework and wasted time.

BETTER APPROVAL RATES
Submit complete, accurate requests every time.

BETTER PATIENT EXPERIENCE
Faster approvals lead to faster care.

Top 10 Reasons Prior Authorizations Get Delayed (and How to Prevent Them)

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Top 10 Reasons Prior Authorization Delays Happen (and How to Prevent Them)

Prior authorization delays don't usually start with the payer — they start before the request is even submitted.

If you're constantly:

chasing missing information

resubmitting requests

dealing with unclear or changing requirements

you're not alone — and it's not random.

This guide walks through the 10 most common breakdown points that cause delays — based on real workflow experience across both provider and payer sides.

For each one, you'll see:

- What actually causes the delay
- Where it shows up in the workflow
- What to fix upfront to prevent it

🔥 What you'll walk away with

- A clearer understanding of where delays actually start
- How to reduce rework and back-and-forth
- What needs to be in place before submission
- How to create a more consistent, predictable workflow

👥 Built for

- Prior authorization specialists
- Intake teams
- Medical assistants working with providers
- Revenue cycle / UM professionals

This isn't theory —

it's built from real-world experience working both sides of the process.

👉 How this fits into the full workflow:

- Start with the **Intake Checklist** → prevent issues before submission
- Use the **Delay Guide** → understand where breakdowns happen
- Upgrade to the **Survival Kit** → full workflow, templates, and systemView all tools: <https://revalnic.gumroad.com>

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Most prior authorization delays aren't caused by the payer — they're caused by what's missed before submission. This guide breaks down the most common reasons requests get delayed — and what you can do to prevent them.

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